

Provenance

Payment holds where the ledger refuses an invented cause

HackCanton Season 4 • Track 1: RWA & Business Workflows

The Problem

When payment rails freeze funds, they say 'ON HOLD' but not WHY. Recipients guess and make costly mistakes.

Real impacts from 4 interviews (Oct 2026):

- Freelancer: \$850 held 9 days → split to dodge → account flagged
- Agency: \$2,400 held 14 days → paid from savings → double-paid
- Engineer: \$4,200 held 6 days → webhook returned reason:null → API keys revoked
- Contractor: \$1,650 held 8 days → opened tickets → lost queue position

The Solution

Provenance = Canton Ledger enforcing honesty — where "don't invent a reason" isn't a promise but a cryptographic rule.

- No 'reason' field to fabricate
- Both parties must sign for release
- Auditor can verify without seeing private data
- Stranger sees NOTHING

Live Demo

GitHub: github.com/HusseinAdeiza/provenance

Demo: provenance-demo.onrender.com